



Marine conservation

Our future may depend on the health of the oceans and the fish stocks they provide. The oceans play a vital part in the food chain that supports not only people, but also the plants and animals living on land. Thankfully, many people are working hard to help conserve the oceans and marine life. We can all play a part by disposing of litter that could end up in the oceans by only buying fish that are in plentiful supply, and by burning less of the fossil fuels that are contributing to global warming.



SAFER FISHING

Improved technology may help to reduce the numbers of seabirds, dolphins, and sea turtles that are accidentally caught by fishing fleets. Specially designed nets enable dolphins and turtles to escape, so they do not get trapped and drown. The long, multi-hooked fishing lines that ensnare albatrosses can be fitted with special bird-scarers to stop the birds from trying to seize the bait.



HELPING OUT

We can all do something to help with marine conservation. For some, this may mean clearing garbage off a nearby seashore. A large amount of plastic garbage ends up in the ocean and because it does not decay, it traps or chokes many marine animals. Leatherback turtles, for example, swallow plastic bags because they look like jellyfish, their main prey.